

DAY 31: WHAT TO DO NOW

Congratulations! You've officially made it to the end of *31 Days*! As you've taken this journey, I hope you've realized just how possible it is to reduce your overall spending. Insurance rates aren't set in stone, utilities fluctuate depending on how much you use them, and it's totally doable to cut your cable bill and never miss one of your favorite shows.

But the savings you've discovered along the way are only the beginning. Now it's time to roll up your sleeves and maintain the progress you've made. To continue mastering your expenses, you need to apply these principles every day, and remember to keep a constant eye on your spending so you don't revert back to old habits.

This means you need to keep this guidebook handy. Store it right beside your financial notebook, on a shelf above your office desk, or front and center on your eReading device. I find mine especially helpful as a reminder whenever I update my finances, or to flip through when an unexpected expense pops up and sends me back to the drawing board.

In fact, you may find it helpful to make this exercise a habit every few months as expenses have an uncanny way of increasing when you least expect it. Schedule a "check-in" on your calendar for 31 days from now so you don't forget. You can choose to go through all 31 days again, or flip through and focus on one target area for a full month. Whatever you do, don't give up when the going gets tough. Remember, you have exactly the right tool at your disposal!

HOW TO USE THOSE EXTRA SAVINGS

Now that your budget is a hundred times healthier (I hope quite literally!), you're in a really exciting place. You have choices, and choices mean lots of possibilities for the future.

In my own life, *31 Days* has given me the ability to buy some of those big-ticket items I've been eyeing for our home, helped me plan a regret-free